



AI cleans photos

A new AI tool can help remove obstructions in photos such as fences, raindrops on windows, etc. <http://digit.in/sep20-17>



Google helps you donate

A new Google Assistant feature allows users to easily donate to NGOs and causes. <http://digit.in/sep20-18>

ASUS ROG Phone 3

Smartphone gaming, personalised

The ROG Phone 3 is the third iteration of Asus' gaming smartphone, a niche it has meticulously carved (along with a handful of others, of course) to serve a growing community of smartphone enthusiasts and gamers. Let's see how the ASUS ROG Phone 3 fared.

Design and display

The ROG Phone 3, when used as a daily driver, feels bulky and unusable due to the form factor. But the ROG Phone 3's build feels logical when you hold it in the gaming grip, and it's meant for gamers. The 6.59-inch panel is the centre of attention on the ROG Phone 3. It doesn't have the modern punch-hole design and instead comes with thin bezels on the top and bottom. Its 144Hz refresh rate is by far the fastest on a smartphone display. The fast touch sampling rate and low latency make this the most responsive panel we've used. Typing, swiping and scrolling on this is monstrously fast. However, the display is not as bright as the OnePlus 8 Pro, or even the ROG Phone II, which is quite disappointing.

Software

When setting up, the ROG Phone 3 offers two UI options — Asus' gaming-flavoured Apex theme or the classic stock Android theme. The underlying interface is essentially stock Android with nearly no additional third-party apps. Within this stock framework, Asus has incorporated the Armoury Crate where we spent the most time. It's a fascinating piece of work. Outside of it, the ROG Phone 3 is like using any other stock Android smartphones, with swift transitions, the Google Discover feed on the home screen, and the overall lightweight, no-frills feel of vanilla Android. There are a few bugs, but over the week we used the phone, there were already two updates fixing some of the issues.



most spectacular gaming performance from the ROG Phone 3.

Camera

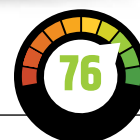
The ROG Phone 3 has a 64MP Sony IMX686 sensor, a 13MP ultrawide lens and a 5MP macro lens. On the front is a single 24MP selfie shooter. During the day, the camera is decent enough. The 64MP primary camera took some good shots during sunset, but the dynamic range and the vibrance are noticeably lacking when compared against the OnePlus 8 Pro.

Battery

With a massive 6,000mAh battery, the ROG Phone 3, even at 144Hz refresh rate, lasted well over 29 hours on a single charge. And this was with endless benchmark runs, gaming and binging Top Gear episodes. Pretty impressive stuff.

Performance

With the internals onboard, the Asus ROG Phone 3 is clearly the most powerful smartphone you can buy right now. Our unit ran on the Snapdragon 865+ along with 8GB LPDDR5 RAM and 128GB UFS 3.0 storage. Asus offers what is perhaps the most personalised gaming experience on a smartphone, and it achieves so using a four-pronged approach — 1) the weight and dimensions add to a vice-like grip when held in landscape orientation for gaming, 2) AirTriggers are not new to the ROG Phone lineup, but this time they have mutated. You can now map up to four functions on the two shoulder buttons, and even bind a function to motion control, 3) The 6.59-inch AMOLED display with the 144Hz response rate and fast touch sampling rate makes this the best gaming smartphone to use in competitive scenarios, 4) The Armoury Crate is the most unique weapon in this phone's arsenal. It's an app where games installed are garaged, giving you stats and recordings, and a place to tune the performance to death, for every individual games. All four aspects combined, what you get is the



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Bottomline

Every element of ASUS ROG Phone 3 has been decided with gaming in mind. An insanely responsive display, cutting-edge hardware, AirTriggers, and

loud audio, offers an unfair advantage against other players using vanilla smartphones. Despite the raw power, the eventual experience offered by the ROG Phone 3 is the same as any other Android flagship of 2020. The ROG Phone 3 can sometimes just feel a bit too overkill, but for good reason.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

OPERATING SYSTEM: Android 10 with ROG UI | CPU: 3.1 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 865 Plus 5G with 7nm, 64-bit Octa-core Processor | GPU: Adreno 650 | INTERNAL STORAGE: 128GB / 256GB UFS 3.1 ROM | MEMORY: 8GB / 12 GB LPDDR5 RAM | BATTERY: 6000 mAh, supports Quick Charge 4.0 and PD Charging | CHARGING: supports up to 30.0W fast charging | REAR CAMERAS: Sony IMX686 64 MP image sensor, 13MP ultrawide lens, 5MP macro lens | VIDEO: rear camera 8K at 30 fps, 4K UHD at 30/60 fps, front camera 1080p at 30/60 fps | FRONT CAMERA: 24MP lens | BLUETOOTH: v5.1 | DISPLAY: 6.59" 2340x1080 144 Hz / 1 ms AMOLED 10-bit HDR display | GLASS: Gorilla Glass 6 | WEIGHT: 240 grams

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